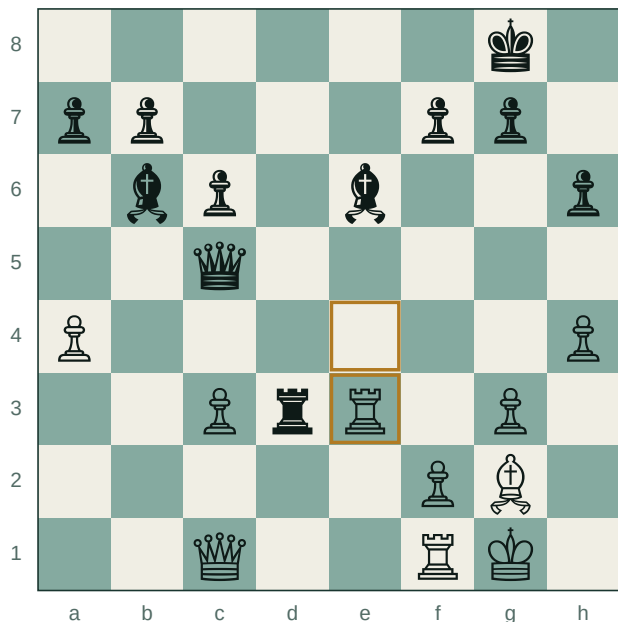


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 23

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Re3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Qxe3 24. fxe3 Bxe3+ 25. Kh2 Bxc1

23...Qxe3 The queen captures the rook on e3. Recorded reply: **24.fxe3**.

24...Bxe3+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From e3 it attacks king on g1 and queen on c1. Recorded reply: **25.Kh2**.

25...Bxc1 The bishop captures the queen on c1.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -1 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.